

If you are self-employed

- ☐ Business tax returns and complete financial statements (including profit/loss statements) for the past two year
- ☐ Your business's most recent Assessment Notice
- ☐ Personal tax returns for the past two years

If you are on benefits

- ☐ Proof of the amount and frequency of Centrelink assistance is required.

Savings

- ☐ Statements that prove you have a history of saving, whether you are an existing customer of the bank you are applying for a loan with, or have those savings with other financial institutions. These documents should cover the past three to six months.

Assets

- ☐ Documentation of what you own
(If you're a first home buyer, it might only be your second-hand bomb car, bought off Gumtree, that you own outright.)

Loans and debts

- ☐ Evidence of current personal and car loans and credit cards, with other banks or credit unions

What you are buying

- ☐ A copy of the sale contract, which you obtain from the real estate agent
Are you buying an off-the-plan apartment? It's best to undertake this application no more than three months from settlement – that is, completion – of the property, by which stage any building hiccups or delays, which make banks nervous, should have passed.

Helping hands

- ☐ A letter outlining a cash gift, perhaps from parents or an inheritance, which must have been deposited into your bank account before you apply for the loan
- ☐ If you received a bonus at work, written proof from your employer for those payments over and above your salary